Exercise

Analysis of IIS web server logs

This exercise introduces log-based investigation. You will analyse Microsoft Internet Information Services (IIS) web server logs to identify suspicious activity, establish a timeline, and reason about what may have occurred.

If you wish to convert the logfile in a TSV (Tab Separated Value) format to review the files in a spreadsheet, you may use a tool like Microsoft's LogParser.

Scenario

You are working as an **incident responder** for an organisation that operates a public-facing web server running **Microsoft Internet Information Services (IIS)**.

The organisation has contacted you after noticing unusual behaviour on their website. At this stage, they are unable to provide detailed technical information and can only supply you with a **single IIS web server log file**, recorded in its native text-based format.

The client reports that:

- There appear to be **multiple repeated requests** to the page default.aspx
- The activity **began at 16:59:14 on 2017-01-09**
- They are unsure whether this behaviour represents normal traffic, a misconfiguration, or malicious activity

Task

Your task is to analyse the provided log file and determine what can be inferred from the available evidence.

Try to complete the following sentences as guidance to your investigation:

1. The website can be accessed on port ……

2. …… web browser(s) have accessed the website.

   Hint: Look for the User Agent

3. The following search terms have been used: ……

   ……

   Hint: Look for /Search

4. These IP addresses were identified: ……

5. The events that took place after the identified suspicious time indicate that

   ……

6. Other items of interest: ……

7. Based on the analysis it appears that ……

   …… happened.

8. My recommendations to the client are: ……

   ……

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